
Understanding Stress in the Body

Companion Workbook — map your body's stress
signature

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

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HEALING HANDS BY NATE

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Continuity Member Edition — Month 1 Workbook

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Introduction

A PRINTABLE COMPANION TO THE MONTH 1 MODULE. Map your body's stress signature.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

PRINT IT. KEEP IT WHERE YOU'LL SEE IT TWICE A day — bathroom counter, desk, kitchen.

This is an awareness workbook, not a fix workbook. You're collecting data on how your own body holds stress. That data is the foundation for everything that comes next.

Bring it to your next session.

CHAPTER 2

Where You Are Today

DO A 60-SECOND BODY SCAN RIGHT NOW. MOVE attention through each station. Mark what you find.

Right now, are you holding tension in:

- [] Jaw (teeth touching, tongue pressed, masseter tight)
- [] Forehead (frowning, behind the eyes)
- [] Neck (chin tucked, stiff)
- [] Shoulders (up toward ears, hunched forward)
- [] Chest (shallow breath, holding breath)
- [] Hands (fists clenched, fingers tight)
- [] Stomach (tight belly)
- [] Hips / Low back (tight low back, hips clenched)
- [] Legs (thighs tensing, toes curled)

Rate baseline stress signals (0 = none, 10 = severe):

Jaw tension during day	[_____]
Shoulders elevated during day	[_____]
Low back tightness without physical cause	[_____]
Headaches (any kind)	[_____]
Shallow breathing	[_____]
Difficulty winding down at end of day	[_____]
Feeling "wired" but tired	[_____]

Three honest sentences about where I feel stress in my body:

1.
2.
3.

CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: THINK BACK TO A RECENT STRESSFUL moment. Where in your body did you feel it first? Where did you feel it most?

Prompt 2: Who or what in your life predictably triggers a stress response in your body? Be specific — a person, a setting, a recurring conversation, a particular task.

Prompt 3: If your body’s stress response had a “preferred storage location,” where would it be? (Yours might be jaw, shoulders, low back, or somewhere different.) When did you first notice it lived there?

CHAPTER 4

7-Day Stress Awareness Tracker

FOR THE NEXT WEEK, DO THE 60-SECOND BODY scan twice a day. At each scan, mark which areas were holding tension.

Daily check pattern

- Morning scan: where am I holding?
 - Afternoon scan: where am I holding?
 - Was there a specific trigger today?
 - Did anything release just by noticing?
-

Day 1 — Date: _____

Morning scan — areas with tension: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan — areas with tension: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Anything release just by noticing? _____

Day 2 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

Day 3 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

Day 4 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders / chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

Day 5 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

Day 6 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

Day 7 — Date: _____

Morning scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Afternoon scan: jaw / forehead / neck / shoulders /
chest / hands / stomach / hips / legs

Specific trigger today: _____

Released by noticing? _____

CHAPTER 5

End-of-Week Reflection

LOOK BACK AT THE SEVEN DAYS.

Top 3 areas where I held tension most often:

1.

2.

3.

Top 3 triggers that caused bracing:

1.

2.

3.

Did just-noticing release tension for me? [Yes often / Sometimes / Rarely / Never]

My personal stress storage pattern looks like:

One commitment for next week:

I will

CHAPTER 6

Try this for 7 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

One 60-second scan per day. That's it. Same time every day. For one week.

Don't worry about fixing anything. Don't worry about morning and afternoon both. Just one scan, once a day, every day.

The awareness alone is the work. Most people are stunned by how often they catch themselves bracing without having any idea.

Bring this workbook to your next session.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
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Nate.